Vandetanib: RET-positive medullary thyroid cancer

This treatment aims to slow cancer growth and help control symptoms. Your team explains the expected benefit, uncertainty and alternatives for your situation.

Medullary thyroid cancer · NCCP 00242 v6 · Document revised 14 November 2026

Your personal plan: this is the standard regimen schedule. Your team confirms your prescribed doses, cycles, treatment changes and appointments in your written plan.

RET mutation positive, unresectable locally advanced or metastatic medullary thyroid cancer.

My overall treatment

Once daily, continuously

28 day reference

Reference window · ongoing treatment

Vandetanib every day — Day 1–28

Treatment

Vandetanib 300 mg once daily, continuously, until progression or unacceptable side effects.

Review

The team reviews the cancer, side effects and your preferences. Scans follow your individual treatment plan; this regimen does not set one universal scan interval.

Your 28-day review window

Day 1–28

Every day, including weekends

Timing may change after review. Side effects can occur on any day; there are no guaranteed safe days.

My tests and checks

When	What is checked	Timing / reason
Before	**Baseline preparation** NCCP	Validated RET mutation test; full blood count, kidney and liver tests, potassium, calcium, magnesium, thyroid-stimulating hormone, electrocardiogram (ECG) and blood pressure. Baseline calcitonin is additionally advised.
During	**Safety checks** NCCP	Blood count, kidney and liver tests at weeks 1, 3, 6 and 12. ECG, potassium, calcium, magnesium and thyroid-stimulating hormone at weeks 1, 3, 6 and 12, then every 3 months for at least a year. Repeat this schedule after a QT-related reduction or interruption longer than 2 weeks. Continue checks after stopping when clinically indicated; monitor blood pressure.
Response	**Cancer-specific checks** Individual specialist plan	RET is the treatment-selection test. Calcitonin is measured at baseline and later when clinically indicated to help assess medullary thyroid cancer. Thyroid-stimulating hormone measures hormone replacement needs.

Between treatments

- Symptoms can occur on any day; use your written contact plan.
- Carry the manufacturer's patient alert card and receive one with every prescription. Report fainting or palpitations urgently. Check every new medicine for heart-rhythm interactions. Diarrhoea can disturb blood salts and increase rhythm risk. Protect skin from sunlight.

Bring your medicines list, calendar and verified contacts.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.

What to watch for

You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

1 Fatigue and neurological symptoms

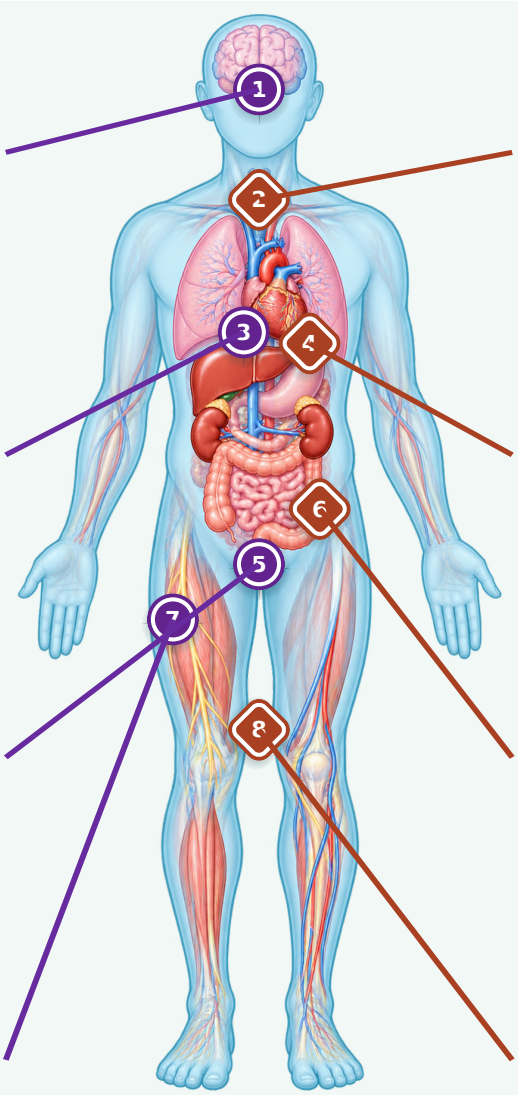
Vandetanib

Balance activity and rest. Sudden confusion, seizure, severe headache or a change in vision needs urgent help.

2 Mouth, eating and swallowing

Vandetanib

Report ulcers, pain, dry mouth, difficulty swallowing or weight loss early. Ask for oral care, dietetic and swallowing support.



3 Heart and blood pressure

Vandetanib

Follow prescribed heart and blood-pressure checks. Chest pain, fainting, palpitations or new breathlessness needs urgent advice.

4 Breathing

Vandetanib

New cough or breathlessness needs prompt review; serious causes include infection or lung injury.

5 Sickness and bowels

Vandetanib

Use prescribed support. Report persistent diarrhoea or vomiting, inability to drink, blood or severe abdominal pain.

6 Kidneys and fluid balance

Vandetanib

Report reduced urine, swelling or poor fluid intake; keep blood and urine tests.

7 Skin, hands and feet

Vandetanib

Report painful palms or soles, rash or blistering early. Severe spreading rash or mouth/eye involvement needs urgent review.

8 Fertility and pregnancy

Vandetanib

Discuss fertility preservation, contraception, pregnancy and breastfeeding before starting.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Call oncology urgently for fever, sudden illness, unusual bleeding, new breathlessness, persistent vomiting or inability to drink. Severe chest pain, severe breathing difficulty, collapse or a seizure: call 112/999.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

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Keep your treatment details to hand

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Print this page **one-sided on A4 at Actual size / 100%**. Cut only the dashed outer border around both panels. **Do not cut the centre line.** Fold with FRONT and BACK facing out, then glue or tape the blank backs together. Finished size: **85.6 × 54 mm**. Keep the stamp side writable.

FRONT / CONTACTS

My Treatment Card

SACTCheck

Name: _____

Vandetanib

Once daily, continuously

Phase: _____ Continuous treatment: team reviews dose

Daytime (EXAMPLE) 087 12345678

Out of hours (EXAMPLE) 087 87654321

Unwell or fever? Call oncology now.
Severe breathing difficulty, chest pain or collapse: **112 / 999.**

EXAMPLE NUMBERS — replace before patient use.

BACK / TREATMENT RECORD

My review record

Recording spaces only; not a fixed course.

Review	Date / initials

My treatment information

Latest review date: _____

Plan changed? Ask the team to update this card.

CUT outer border

FOLD centre — do not cut

Keep the record accurate

The team records each review and the current daily dose. Recording boxes do not imply a fixed course or a rest period. Record any held dose or changed plan. An entry does not authorise a restart; keep any medicine-specific alert card too.

Put your treatment page on your phone

Scan your QR and check the treatment name. Save that page to your home screen.

iPhone / Safari

Tap Share → Add to Home Screen. Select Open as Web App if offered, then Add.

Android / Chrome

Tap the three-dot menu → Add to Home screen or Install and create shortcut. Choose the shortcut option and confirm.

Menu wording varies. The QR opens information, not a personal record. Paper stamps do not update the website. Check that the saved icon opens the correct treatment.

Your local contacts and resources

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Hospital / team: _____

Backup if the team cannot be reached: _____

Additional local services and resources will be added when confirmed. Your team must check and complete this page before patient use.

Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.